Southern Cross University

Introductory Pharmacology PHAR2001

Therapeutic Goods Administration (TGA) Drug scheduling

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Standard for the uniform scheduling of drugs in Australia

Schedule:

- 1: (no current medications are in this schedule)
- 2: Pharmacy medication
- 3: Pharmacist only medication
- 4: Prescription only medication
- 4, appendix D: Prescribe restricted substances
- 5: Household substances that need appropriate labelling
- 6: Agricultural, veterinary and industrial substances
- 7: Dangerous poisons
- 8: Controlled drugs
- 9: Prohibited substances (may be abused)

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Generally know schedules 2, 3, 4, 8 and 9

Simply know information on previous slide.

Questions will be similar to "pharmacy only medications" would be classified as schedule 2, 3, 4, 8

- Answer: 3

...or "a medication that is classified as Schedule 3 would be..." Pharmacy medication, Pharmacist only medication, Prescription only medication, Controlled drugs

- Answer: Pharmacist only

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Medicinal preparations and abbreviations

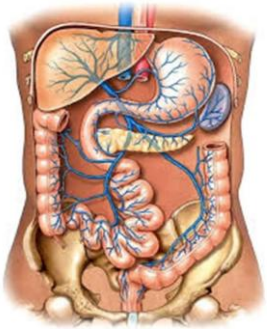
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Medicinal preparations

- Tablets
- Enteric-coated preparations
- Capsules
- Etc...

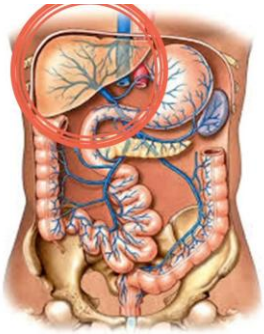
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Hepatic first pass

Any medication absorbed from the middle portion of the oesophagus to the middle portion of the rectum goes through the liver first.

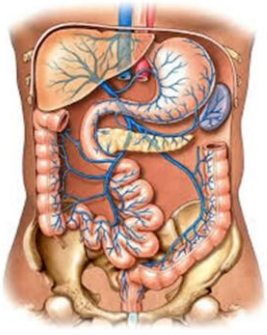
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Any medication absorbed from the middle portion of the oesophagus to the middle portion of the rectum goes through the liver first.

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Drugs with a high 'first pass' will not be able to be taken orally

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Check out the table of medicinal preparations in the Blackboard site!

…or see the next two slides…

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Quick check table of medicine formulations For optimal retention of this information, please print, fold on double line and quiz yourself!		
Medicine formulation	**Description**	**Cautions, adverse effects, comments**
"Pills"	Original name of round or oval oral medicine that was sugar coated.	While your patient may use the term for any of their oral medications, it is best that you use the precise term.
Tablets	A disc containing compressed mix of the drug and normally some inert substance that expands on contact with water to aid digestion.	May taste bad or be hard to swallow; may be sugar-coated to help overcome these problems.
Enteric-coated preparations; EC preparations	A tablet that is formulated to optimise disintegration in the intestines instead of the stomach.	NOT TO BE CHEWED OR CRUSHED. Cannot be used in a feeding tube. If the person finds them difficult to swallow, controlled release capsules may be better
Capsules (hard) Capsules (soft)	Soft capsules are completely sealed by gelatine; inside there is a liquid such as fish oil. Hard capsules can be opened and the powdered contents sprinkled on food.	Hard capsules can often have distinctive colours and can be more easily identified in emergency situations. They are often easier to swallow than tablets.
Sustained release preparations	A preparation that dissolves over a longer period of time in the gastrointestinal tract.	Helps patients who are non-compliant, and with drugs that have a short half-life. The dissolution of the substances may be very variable between patients or conditions in the GIT.
Controlled release preparations	A preparation that attempts to make release more consistent between patients than sustained release (by placing a tiny laser-hole in the active beads).	Instruct the individual that "tablet ghosts" may be found in the faeces but this does not mean the active substance has not dissolved.
Oral liquid preparations	Linctus is syrup for coughs. Tinctures contain alcohol; Emulsions do not contain alcohol but shake before use.	A good solution to the exact dose needed for children; easy to swallow.

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Topical preparations (Drops)	Provides the medicine directly into the ears (oily) or eyes.	Do not use oily drops in the nose as this hinders the ciliary action of the nasal mucosa.
Topical preparations (creams)	Has a water base which evaporates and leaves a film on skin.	Some systemic absorption can occur.
Topical preparations (ointments)	Lipid (fat) - based so they often have a greasy feel.	Much more absorption into the body occurs with ointments.
Topical preparations (gels or lotions)	Contains alcohol instead of oil to decrease greasy feel.	May not get much of the active substance through as the alcohol evaporates quickly. Steroidal hormones are often administered in this way.

Abbreviations	
Twice daily	bd
Three times daily	tds
Four times daily	qid
Intravenous	IV
Intramuscular	IM
Oral	PO

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Australian Drug Evaluation Committee (ADEC) Pregnancy Categories

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The ADEC: Australian Drug Evaluation Committee Pregnancy Categories

Indicate a drug's potential or actual teratogenicity

Pregnancy category A: no adverse effects on the foetus

Pregnancy category D: definite adverse effect

Pregnancy category X: terotogenic (not to be used by any woman of child bearing age

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Indicate a drug's potential or actual teratogenicity

Pregnancy category B: This category is not hierarchical (do not expect B to be always better than C or worse than A)

Pregnancy category B in Australia means that there is inadequate information to determine the exact risk.

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